cheating. The law redefines the legal relation between consumers of goods and services and their sellers or manufacturers.

This act has two important implications for the consumer:

- Firstly, it gives him the right to complain to an authority when aggrieved and seek redressal speedily without much haste.
- Secondly, the consumer can claim compensation for any loss or injury suffered on account of the negligence of the manufacturer.

The act applies to all goods and services except those rendered free of charge or under a personal service contract. Any complaint of deficiency in the service rendered to a consumer, or loss caused due to an unfair trade practice, can form the subject for proceedings under the act.

Features of Consumer Protection Act:

i) Group of Consumer's Rights:

This act provides many rights to consumers. These rights are related to safety, information, choice, representation, redressal, education etc.

ii) Effective Safeguards:

This Act provides safety to consumers regarding defective products, dis satisfactory services and unfair trade practices. So under the purview of this Act there is a provision to ban all those activities which can cause a risk for consumer.

iii) Three-tier Grievances Redressal Machinery:

Consumer courts have been established so that the consumers can enjoy their rights. This Act presents Three- tier Grievances Redressal Machinery:

a. At District Level-District Forum
b. At State Level -State Commission
c. At National Level – National Commission.

iv) Time Bound Redressal:

A main feature of the Act is that under this, the judgment for the cases are decided in a limited time of period.

v) Consumer Protection Council:

To favour consumer protection and to encourage consumer awareness, there is a provision in this act to establish consumer protection councils. It ensures consumer's right to seek redressal if any grievance arise.

2.7.4 Consumer Redressal Forum

The judiciary bodies are set up by the government to protect the consumer rights. Its main function is to maintain the fair practices by the sellers towards consumers. Consumers can file a case against a seller if they are harassed or exploited by sellers. The court will only give a verdict in favour of the consumers if they have proof of exploitation, i.e., bills or other documents.

i) Who Can File a Complaint?

The following categories of persons can file a complaint

- aggrieved consumer
- any voluntary consumer organisation, registered under the Societies Registration Act, 1860, or the Companies Act, 1956,
- the Central Government
- the State Governments or Union Territory Administrations

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